

What You're Taking With You

The last journal. Do it at the end of the fourth week, after a sit. Plan on an hour. This is the one you'll bring to your Integration and Next-Step Session, so write it for the two of us.

Four weeks ago you started with the breath. Look back over the month, in the body: what you're taking with you, what's still open, and what you want from our hour together.

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Five minutes of breath. Five in, seven out. Then, before you write anything, note the quality of mind you're starting with. Calm and clear, jumpy and agitated, dull and heavy. Write one word.

1. WHERE YOU STARTED

Go back to the first journal, What's Bringing You Here, and read what you wrote in the first days. Then close your eyes and let it land in the body. What's happening in there now, as you hear your own words from a month ago? Where, and what's the quality?

2. WHAT THE BODY LEARNED

Not what you understood. What the body can do now that it couldn't four weeks ago. Can you find the sensation faster? Stay with it longer? Feel the difference between the story and what's there? Write it plainly, and small is fine.

3. ONE MOMENT FROM THE MONTH

Choose one moment from the four weeks when you did the thing. You slowed the breath. You stayed thirty seconds longer. You named the trade. You said the one honest sentence. Describe it the way you'd tell me: what happened, what you did, and what happened in the body.

4. WHAT'S STILL RUNNING

And one place where the old pattern is still running you. No shame. We don't do shame here. Just name it. Which kid has the wheel there, and what is it protecting?

5. WHAT CHANGED IN A RELATIONSHIP

Did anything change, even slightly, in how you were with someone this month? A pause you took, a sentence you said, a trade you didn't make. If nothing did, write that. It's useful for our hour either way.

6. WHAT YOU BRUSHED

All month you've been staying with the tightness. Underneath it there's usually something more tender. If you brushed it this month, in a sit or a journal, write what you know about it so far. Where it lives, what it's like. If you haven't, write that. Either is the right answer for our hour. Don't dig here.

7. WHAT YOU WANT FROM OUR HOUR

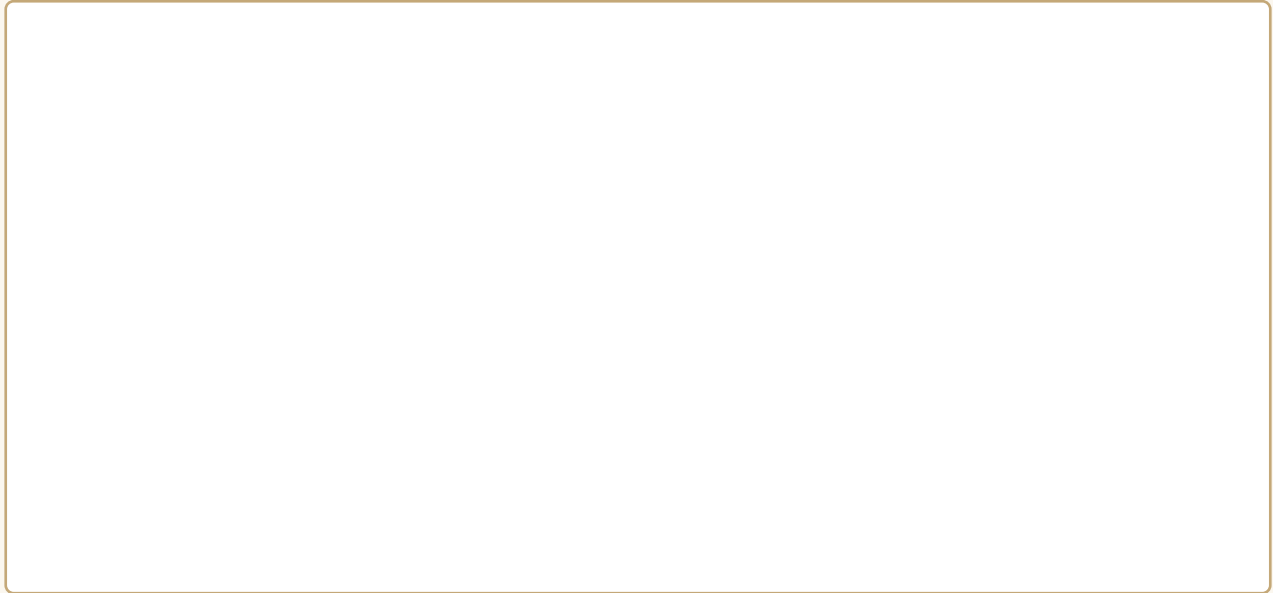
We meet for an hour after this. What do you want from it? What would you want named, or worked on, or asked?

8. YOUR PRACTICE GOING FORWARD

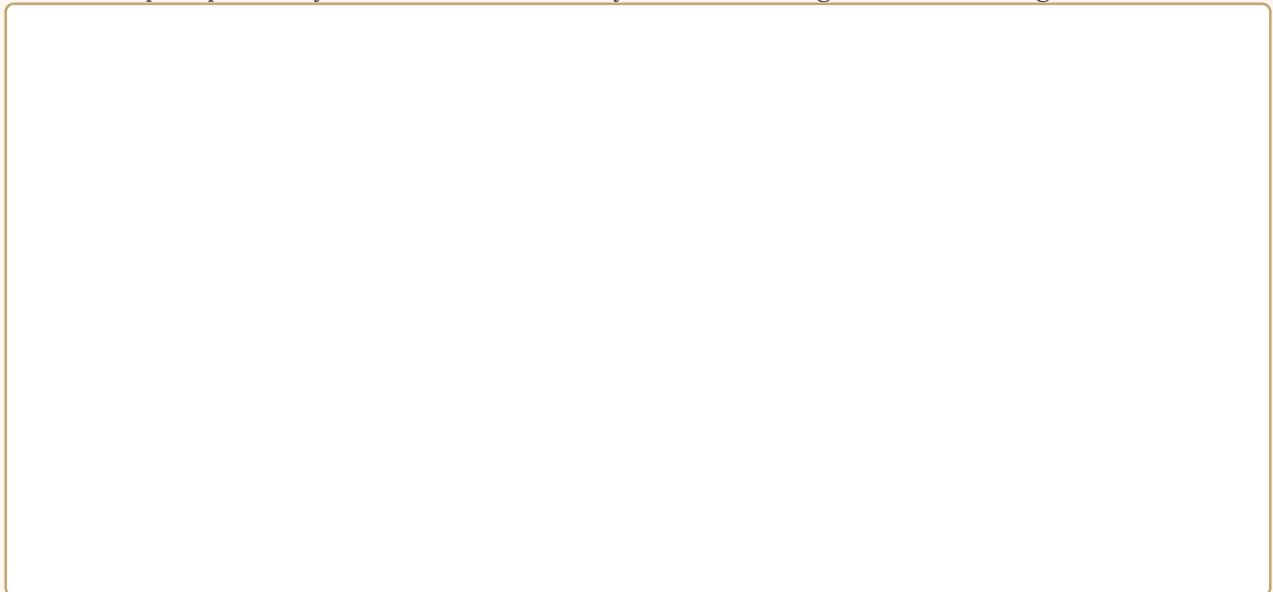
Fifteen minutes of breath a day is the practice I'd ask of anyone. What's yours going to be? When, where, which recording. And one place in your week you'll practice when nothing much is wrong.

CLOSING THE MONTH

What's one thing you're taking with you from these four weeks?

A large, empty rectangular box with a thin brown border, intended for the user to write their response to the question above.

What's an open question you're left with, the one you want to bring into our hour together?

A large, empty rectangular box with a thin brown border, intended for the user to write their response to the question above.

Note the quality of mind you're ending with, and compare it to where you began.

